

The colloquy of mobiles is a social allegory.

- The exhibit contains two sorts of individual; central mobiles and outer mobiles.
- The goal of a central mobile is to have a beam of light from its middle spotlight play upon its receptive surfaces (the white on black vanes).
- The goal of an outer mobile is to reflect light back onto these surfaces in a way that satisfies the central mobile (upwards for one of them and downwards for the other).
- To achieve these goals, pairs of central and outer mobiles must co-operate; further, the two central mobiles compete amongst themselves for co-operative opportunities. Either co-operation or competition involves communication between members of the group. The communicative vocabulary is shown below.

Central Mobile

- Level of drive for goal achievement = Intensity of Light above Mobiles.
- Sufficient drive to interact = Lower Left Display Panel
- Wants to stop and co-operate = Lower Right Display Panel
- Dominates the other central mobile = Upper Display Panels
- Asks outer mobile to co-operate = Flashing of Spotlight Beam
- Tries to achieve satisfactory response = Full Intensity Spotlight Beam.
- Satisfaction obtained if beam is reflected, by an outer mobile, onto white on black receptive surfaces = Lamps on the Black on White Vanes and Auditory Signal.

Outer Mobiles

- Level of drive for achieving its goal = Intensity of Illumination of the entire figure. The drive level increases if a goal is not reached.
- Wants to interact = Upper Display Lamps
- Agrees to co-operate = Auditory Signal
- Memory state = Pair of Coloured Display Lamps
- Searching to reflect light beam in a satisfactory manner = Motion of Reflector and Middle Light Receptor.